

Debugging

In 2013, NASSCOM had predicted that the Software Testing industry would grow from USD 30 billion in 2010 to over USD 50 billion in 2020 and India was expected to be the largest beneficiary of this growth. They weren't far from the mark as the industry did exceed USD 40 billion in 2019 and is expected to grow at a CAGR of over 6 per cent from 2020 to 2026. Over the last couple of years, there has been a perceived slow down in the growth of the software testing industry. Some blame it on improved toolkits and IDEs which have gotten better at spotting bugs in the development phase itself, reducing the amount of work that software testers have to do. Others blame it on the industry trend of downsizing of Internal QA teams in favour of having larger “Beta Testers” who'd do the job that Internal QA teams would have done. We'd like to point out that software has only gotten worse because of this practice. However, what's also happened is the introduction of more complex paradigms which have led to a greater demand for specialists.

Automation is spreading like wildfire in the software development world. More and more industries are incorporating AI-enabled bots to do mundane and repetitive work, thus freeing up humans to take up the more important tasks. Although the term “Freeing up” can also be read as downsizing, these automatons or bots aren't easy to debug as the ones that came before. Bots are inherently easy to implement but troubleshooting them isn't quite so as you require a more advanced skill-set to identify the goof-ups and set them right. Also, since bots are way faster than humans, it's absolutely imperative to speed up the testing process since the potential for damage is much higher as an erroneous bot can produce a lot more work that needs fixing.